UK Mobile Data Market — Brief & Sample

Pricing · Handset ex-factory margins · Market & marketing context | 6GGW / NetSwitch · prepared for Sami Leino · 31 Jul 2026

measured = reported figure | modelled = computed from a stated assumption

£0.10–£1.67
SIM-only price per GB across the market

1.6–2.8×
handset RRP (ex-VAT) over bill-of-materials

£15.73
postpaid ARPU / month (2023)

83%
UK population on 5G standalone (2025)

1 · SIM-only pricing (measured, mid-2026)

Headline list prices. Note how the four physical networks (EE, O2, Vodafone, Three) resell through MVNOs at a fraction of the per-GB rate.

Operator	Type	Runs on	Plan	Data	£/mo	£/GB
Three	MNO	Three	Unlimited SIM	∞	22.00	—
Three	MNO	Three	10GB SIM	10	6.00	0.60
EE	MNO	EE	Unlimited SIM	∞	40.00	—
O2	MNO	O2	Entry SIM	3	5.80	1.93
Vodafone	MNO	Vodafone	Unlimited SIM	∞	26.00	—
Smarty	MVNO	Three	~30GB rolling	30	8.00	0.27
Smarty	MVNO	Three	Unlimited	∞	12.00	—
iD Mobile	MVNO	Three	120GB	120	12.00	0.10
iD Mobile	MVNO	Three	Unlimited	∞	16.00	—
Lebara	MVNO	Vodafone	5GB	5	5.00	1.00
Voxi	MVNO	Vodafone	Unlimited	∞	15.00	—
Tesco Mobile	MVNO	O2	5GB	5	7.50	1.50
ASDA Mobile	MVNO	Vodafone	3GB	3	5.00	1.67

Read: the cheapest effective data on the market is an MVNO large-bundle (iD Mobile 120GB ≈ £0.10/GB); MNO own-brand plans carry a 3–15× per-GB premium for brand + support + roaming certainty.

2 · Handset ex-factory margin waterfall

BOM = bill-of-materials (teardown estimate, measured). Ex-factory is **modelled** as BOM × 1.30 (assembly, test, maker's margin). RRP shown ex-VAT as the trade value. FX 1 USD = £0.79.

Model	BOM £	Ex-factory £*	RRP ex-VAT £	Gross margin	Markup ×BOM
iPhone 15 Pro Max	440.82	573.07	999.17	55.9%	2.27×
Galaxy S23 Ultra	370.51	481.66	1040.83	64.4%	2.81×
Flagship (generic)	410.80	534.04	958.33	57.1%	2.33×
Mid-range (generic)	181.70	236.21	332.50	45.4%	1.83×
Budget (generic)	82.95	107.84	132.50	37.4%	1.60×

> ***Ex-factory is modelled, not a quoted number.** Real ex-factory prices are confidential. BOM excludes assembly, software, IP/royalties, logistics, warranty and marketing — the gross margin above is the pool those are paid from, not net profit. Change `EXFACTORY_MULT` in the generator to re-price the whole column.

3 · Market & marketing context

Metric	Value	Period	Segment	Basis
Postpaid ARPU	£15.73/mo	2023	postpaid	measured
Prepaid ARPU	£5.18/mo	2023	prepaid	measured
VMO2 total connections	45.7M	2024	all	measured

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5G SA population coverage	83%	2025	all	measured
Mobile data usage growth	+18% YoY	2025	all	measured
MVNO consumer share (Sky+Tesco)	>15%	2025	MVNO	measured
Marketing spend of revenue	~12%	2026	all	**modelled**
Cost per acquisition (SIM)	~£18	2026	all	**modelled**

> The two marketing rows are **modelled placeholders** so the report has the dimension end-to-end. Send me your real marketing spend / CPA / ROI figures (or a source) and they drop straight in — nothing else changes.

How the sample feeds your report engine

The attached bundle is driven by one generator so the numbers are reproducible and easy to extend:

File	What it is
plans.csv / handsets.csv / market.csv	the three tidy tables above — feed these to the report engine
uk_data_market_sample.json	all three tables + meta/assumptions in one JSON
gen_sample.py	regenerates everything; `--check` verifies invariants; deterministic checksum
data_dictionary.md	column-by-column schema + the modelling assumptions

Sources: UK operator price lists & comparison sites (mid-2026); handset BOM from TechInsights/IHS-style teardown estimates; Ofcom Connected Nations 2025 & telecoms market data; Ofcom/Statista ARPU (2023). Measured figures are reported; modelled figures are computed from the stated assumptions (FX £0.79/USD, ex-factory ×1.30, VAT 20%) and are clearly flagged. This is a sample — say the word and I'll widen the plan set, add more handsets, or swap in your own marketing numbers.

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